



**United
Nations**

Department of
Economic and
Social Affairs



Local E-Government Toolkit

Empowering Local Governments Through Digital Transformation

Institutional Framework

Indicator	Description
<u>1. #281 Municipal portal</u>	Existence of an official city government-provided website
<u>2. #215 Organization structure</u>	Existence of an organizational structure or chart of the local government
<u>3. #216 Names and titles of heads of department</u>	Information on local government heads and contacts of head of department
<u>4. #224 Rights to access government information</u>	Information (content or documents) regarding people's rights to access government information
<u>5. #235 Open data policy</u>	Existence of government information proactively disclosed and made available online for everyone's access, reuse and redistribution without restriction
<u>6. #242 Links for government agencies</u>	Existence of links to any local/regional/national government agencies



1. Municipal Portal (#281)

What	An official city government-provided website, which can be identified by the following: i) the domain name with the abbreviations for government (i.e.: gov; gob etc.) and for the city or country, ii) at the bottom of the page, the copyright (©) should mention the name of the city for that portal, e.g.: "Copyright © ... City. All Rights Reserved".
Why	Enhances transparency, improves communication with residents, and provides easy access to essential services and information, promoting civic engagement and efficiency in local governance.
How?	Recommended steps: 1. Choose a Domain Name and Hosting: a. Select a domain name that represents your municipality and register it through a domain registrar 2. Install a Content Management System (CMS): a. Choose a CMS like WordPress, Joomla, or Drupal 3. Select a Theme: a. Choose a responsive and user-friendly theme that suits the municipality's aesthetics and requirements For more information check out the U.S. Web Design System (USWDS) Guide or the UK government's design principles or the Europa Web Guide
Case Examples 	For a list of cities' website portals, check out this page by UN DESA and click on each city to see their portals



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About Municipal Portals Globally According to the 2024 UN DESA E-Government Survey



151/193 cities assessed in LOSI of 2024 have accessible and assessed e-government portals



42 cities lack evaluated portals, down from 47 cities in 2022



What	A diagrammatic representation of the structure of a government organization or agency. It illustrates the hierarchy, relationships, roles, and responsibilities of various departments, units, and positions within the government.
Why	A government organogram promotes transparency, accountability, efficient communication, people engagement, service access, and even legal and regulatory compliance in some cases.
How?	Visual Representation: - Create a clear and concise diagram outlining the municipal organization's structure. Accessibility and Transparency: - Publish the diagram prominently on the municipal portal for easy public access. - Ensure the diagram is in a widely compatible format (e.g., PDF or PNG) for easy viewing. Detailed Descriptions: - Provide brief descriptions of each department or unit represented in the diagram. - Include contact information, key responsibilities, and services offered by each department. Regular Updates: - Reflect any changes in staffing, departments, or reporting lines to maintain accuracy. Check out Canva's guide on creating organizational chart
Case Examples	Check out Buenos Aires' Organogram (Only in Spanish) or Oslo's Organizational Chart





3. Names and titles of heads of department (#216)

What	A section, chart or webpage displaying the names, official titles, and contact information (such as phone numbers and email addresses) of individuals leading various government departments or ministries.
Why	This information allows people, businesses, or other stakeholders to directly communicate with the heads of these departments regarding specific matters, services, or concerns. It also promotes transparency, accountability, and accessibility.
How?	Indicative Steps: 1. Gather Information: a. Collect the names, official titles, and contact details (phone numbers and email addresses) of department heads. 2. Create a New Webpage: a. Within your content management system (CMS), create a new webpage dedicated to this information or insert it into your organizational chart (see previous slide). 3. Regular Updates: a. Commit to keeping the information up-to-date, reflecting any changes in department leadership.
Case Examples  	Check out Montevideo's Authorities' Section and Dublin's Contact Us page

What	Content or documents regarding citizens' rights to access government (such as the Freedom of Information Act or Access to Information Act).
Why	The right to access information enables all individuals to know how the decisions that affect them are made, how public funds are handled and according to which criteria institutions act.
How?	Indicative Steps: Legal Compliance: - Ensure the portal aligns with national Freedom of Information Act or similar legislation. Clear Information: - Provide a dedicated section outlining people's rights to access government data. Document Accessibility: - Upload relevant acts, policies, and guidelines related to information access in PDFs, HTML Request Submission: - Provide an online form for people to submit information requests. Data Security: - Assure people about the security of their personal data during the request process. Check out the ICO's guide for public authorities on applying freedom of information or the UK Governments' Freedom of Information Code of Practice
Case Examples 	Check out Sofia's Right of access by the data subject page



5. Open data policy (#236)

What	Open Government Data (OGD) can be defined as government information proactively disclosed and made available online for everyone's access, reuse and redistribution without restriction.
Why	By making information accessible to people, it promotes transparency, accountability, innovation, efficiency, and people engagement, and fosters trust in public institutions.
How?	Indicative Steps: Data Assessment: - Identify relevant datasets for public interest. Policy Formation: - Establish data standards, formats, and update schedules. Technical Implementation: - Choose user-friendly data portal software and Ensure APIs for seamless data access Legal & Ethical Considerations: - Address privacy concerns and data protection and Apply open data licenses Monitoring & Improvement: - Regularly update datasets based on demand and relevance. Check out UNDP's Open Government Data Policies and Practices with select country cases guide
Case Examples 	Check out Bratislava's open data policy

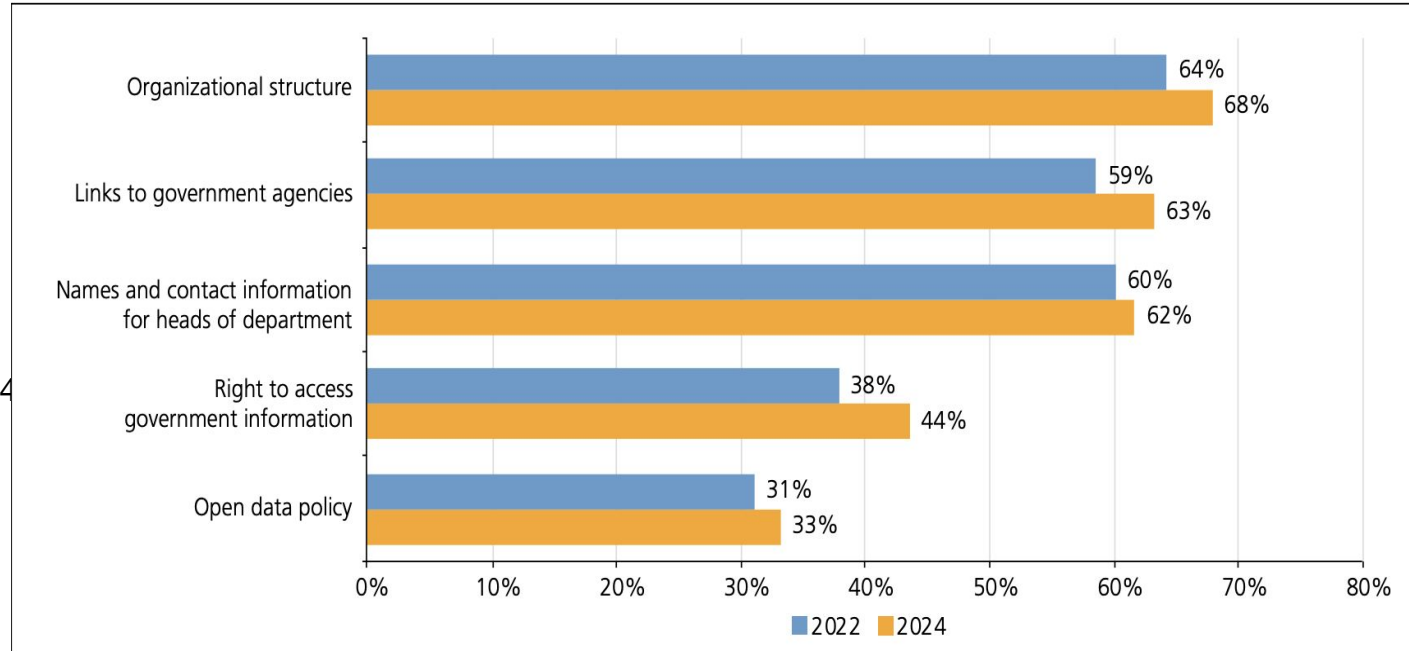


6. Links for government agencies (#242)

What	A dedicated section of relative hyperlinks to local/regional/national government agencies' official websites.
Why	These links serve as direct access points, allowing residents to quickly find specific agency information, services, and resources.
How?	Indicative Steps 1. Identify Agencies: a. List the government agencies relevant to your audience and region. 2. Create a Section: a. Add a dedicated section on your website, clearly labelled "Government Links" or similar. 3. Provide Direct URLs: a. Include direct website links to each agency. Keep it concise and organized for easy navigation. 4. Update Regularly: a. Ensure the links are current and functional. Regularly verify and update the URLs for accuracy. For more tips, check out US GSA's external links section or the UK's guide on Adding links to content.
Case Examples	Check out Singapore' Government Directory Page



Implementation of institutional framework indicators in city portals (percentage of cities)



Source: UN E-Government Survey 2024, UN DESA

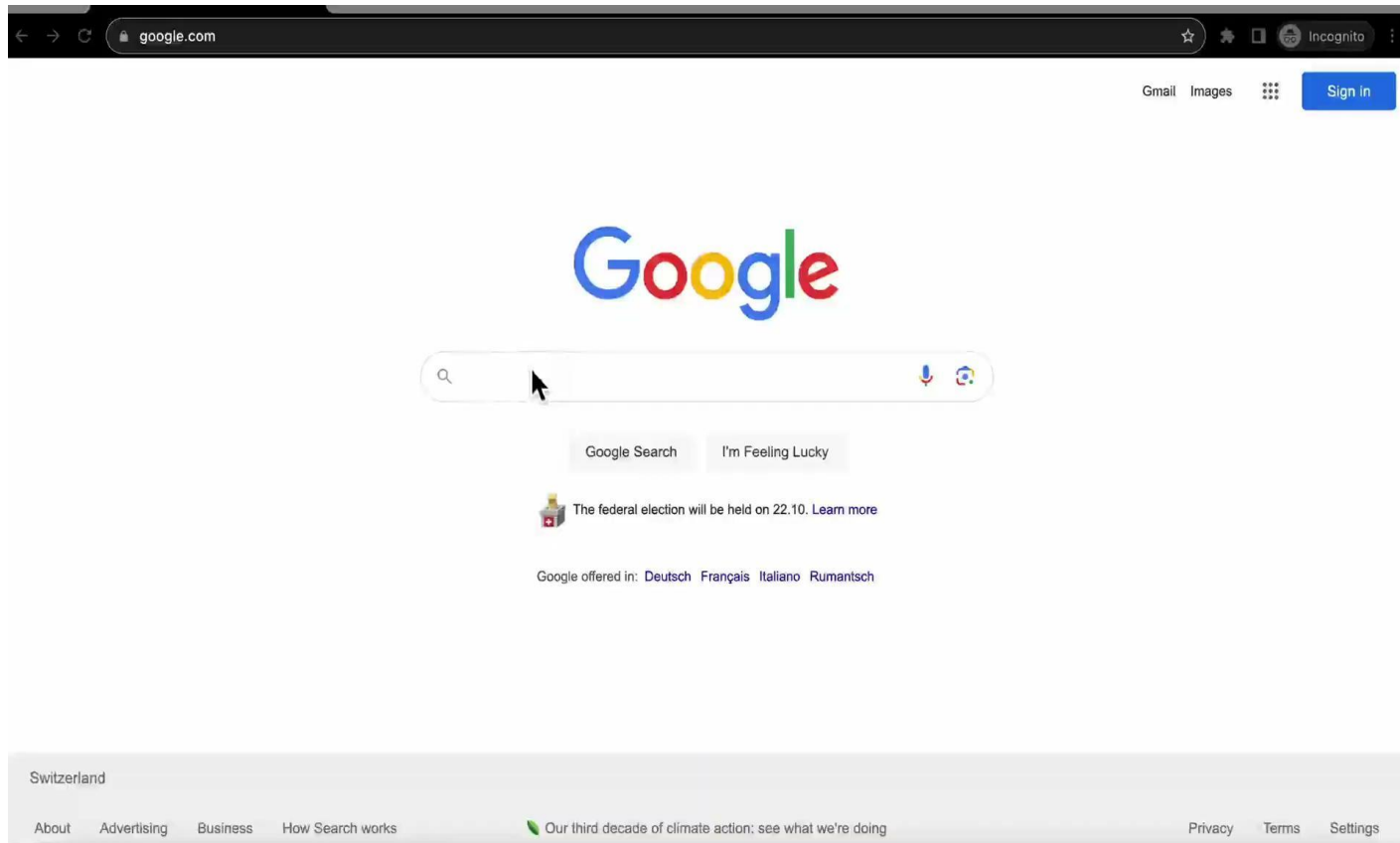
These numbers are represented by the 151 cities assessed for the 2024 LOSI



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Indicators 1.1-1.6: Case Example – Toronto



DESA Public Institutions

